

A night of disciplined evacuation: Dharamsala IPL match halted, crowd praised for composure

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It was supposed to be just another IPL evening in the mountains — a league-stage clash between two teams scrambling to make it into the top four. But what began as a regular league fixture between Punjab Kings and Delhi Capitals at the HPCA Stadium in Dharamsala ended in a mid-match evacuation following reports of drone incursions within a 100-kilometre radius. IPL chairman Arun Dhumal, present at the venue, was seen assisting officials and spectators in vacating the premises, stepping in during a situation the tournament had never faced before.

Tensions had already been simmering in the background following India's retaliatory strikes on nine terror camps across Pakistan and Pakistan-occupied Kashmir. The strikes came after weeks of escalating

tensions between the neighbours over the terrorist attacks in the picturesque town of Pahalgam in Kashmir on April 22, which left 26 people dead.

With military escalation in the region, uncertainty loomed over whether the match would proceed. However, it was decided the game would go ahead as planned.

In the hours leading up to the match, the town retained its characteristic calm. Fans, mostly in Punjab red, flowed through the narrow lanes towards the